The One True Gospel

Turning from grace is desertion from Christ Himself. Adding law to grace doesn't modify the gospel — it replaces it, and any other gospel stands under God's curse.

Where this study fits

Galatians · sixteen studies · this study highlighted

01 1:1–5 The Ground of Liberty	**02** 1:6–10 The One True Gospel	**03** 1:11–17 Paul's Independent Revelation	**04** 1:18–2:10 Paul's Gospel Is Independent of the Judean Churches
05 2:11–21 Peter Goes Back to School	**06** 3:1–5 Under a Spell	**07** 3:6–14 Blessing or a Curse	**08** 3:15–29 The Superiority of the Promise to the Law
09 4:1–11 When I Became a Man	**10** 4:12–20 A Steel Fist in a Velvet Glove	**11** 4:21–31 Paul's Old Testament Story	**12** 5:1–12 Taking a Stand in Liberty
13 5:13–26 Walk in the Spirit	**14** 6:1–5 Brothers and Burdens	**15** 6:6–10 Sowing and Reaping	**16** 6:11–18 Teaching the Truth

The passage at a glance

Galatians 1:6–10 · Outline from the posted Part 1 table

I. The Galatians' Desertion · vv.6–7

- A · Turning from grace is military desertion — voluntary and already underway
- B · Deserted from Christ, the One who called them
- C · Deserted to a perverted gospel — law added to grace replaces it

II. The Curse · vv.8–9

- A · Unlikely scenario: even Paul or an angel would be accursed
- B · Likely scenario: the Judaizers preaching a different gospel now
- Scripture alone is the test of truth

III. Paul's Wisdom · v.10

- Paul serves Christ, not human approval
- Grace, not works, is what glorifies Jesus

Deserting — and so soon

Galatians 1:6 · Outline I.A–B

“You are turning away”

μετατίθεσθε metatithesthe · Pres. Mid. Ind. 2nd Pl.

Military term — a soldier deserting his post in battle

Present tense — already underway

Middle voice — self-initiated, voluntary

“So soon” — within about a year of Paul's visit

From whom? To what?

From Him who called you

τοῦ καλέσαντος Aor. Act. Ptc. — the caller is Christ, not Paul

in the grace of Christ — **χάριτι** (dative): the sphere of the call

To a different gospel

A counterfeit with additions and requirements — no good news at all

It was never really about the messenger: to reject the grace gospel is to reject the One who called — Jesus Christ Himself.

“A different gospel, which is not another”

Galatians 1:6–7 · Outline I.C

Different in kind **ἕτερος** heteron · G2087	**Another of the same kind** **ἄλλος** allo · G243
• What the Judaizers preach (v.6) • A categorically different message	• What it is not (v.7) • No legitimate alternative gospel exists — only imitations

v.6–7	“gospel” — three times in two verses: which good news?	**εὐαγγέλιον** only one is entitled to the name
v.7	“some who trouble you” — confusion replacing settled confidence	**ταράσσοντες** Pres. Act. Ptc. — ongoing
v.7	“want to pervert the gospel of Christ”	**μεταστρέψαι** to turn to the opposite — invert it

Two scenarios, one verdict

Galatians 1:8–9 · Outline II.A–B

Unlikely — v.8

- “Even if we, or an angel from heaven”
- Even Paul himself is not exempt

Likely — v.9

- “If anyone preaches any other gospel”
- The Judaizers in Galatia, now

“Let him be accursed”

ἀνάθεμα anathema · G331

- Something devoted to destruction
- LXX: renders Hebrew חֵרֶם (cherem), the ban (Josh 6:17)
- Said twice — “as we have said before, so now I say again”
- The test is the message, measured by the Word — not the messenger

Pleasing men, or serving Christ?

Galatians 1:10 · Outline III — Paul's wisdom

v.10a	“Do I now persuade men, or God?” — the charge: a gospel shaped to win favor	**πείθω** persuade; seek to win favor
v.10b	“Or do I seek to please men?”	**ἀρέσκω** to please, accommodate
v.10c	“I would not be a bondservant of Christ”	**δοῦλος** one Master — not Christ and the crowd

Serving from fear

- Unsure enough has been done to be saved — or to stay saved
- Works become a way to keep the account settled

Serving from love

- Jesus has already paid the debt in full
- “The love of Christ compels us” (2 Cor 5:14)

Discuss and apply

Galatians 1:6–10 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. According to 1:6b, whose call were the Galatians actually rejecting when they abandoned Paul's gospel — and why does that matter?

2. Why does Paul pronounce the same curse (ἀνάθεμα) on an unlikely messenger and a likely one?

Apply

Grace Cannot Be Improved Upon

Write out in one sentence how a person receives eternal life. Check it against Ephesians 2:8–9 and John 3:16.

Test Every Message Against the Word

Pick one teaching you've accepted secondhand and trace it back to see whether it holds up against the Word.

In one line: There is one gospel — grace — and anything added to it is no gospel at all.